READINESS CHECKLIST FOR LEGAL AND IT

Legal AI on Microsoft 365: a readiness checklist for legal and IT.

Legal AI on Microsoft runs inside the organization's own tenant, under the identity, security, and retention controls IT already maintains. That makes the first deployment a joint decision: legal chooses the work and writes down its positions, and IT confirms the licences, policies, and approvals the work depends on. These are the questions the two settle together before the first practice goes live.

- [ ] **The first practice** LEGAL
  Which practice comes first, and which two or three recurring tasks?
- [ ] **Licences** IT
  Who on the practice team holds a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence?
- [ ] **Cowork** IT
  Is Cowork enabled for the legal team, and under which usage policy?
- [ ] **Approvals** LEGAL AND IT
  Who approves the plugins and connectors the practice needs?
- [ ] **Labels and retention** LEGAL AND IT
  How do sensitivity labels and retention apply to the practice's documents and to Copilot activity?
- [ ] **Deployment route** LEGAL AND IT
  Will the practice deploy itself, or will IT deploy centrally?

FOR IT

IT confirms the licences, policies, and approvals the practice depends on.

- [ ] **Licences**
  Which members of the practice team hold a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, and is Copilot for Legal available to them in Word?
  The legal skills in Word and the Legal for Cowork plugin are what the accelerator builds on.

- [ ] **Cowork usage policy**
  Is Cowork enabled for the legal team, which models may it use, and what usage policy and capacity apply?
  Cowork runs the multi-file work, such as reviewing a set of agreements or invoices.

- [ ] **Plugins and connectors**
  Who approves plugins in the plugin registry, and the connectors the practice needs, such as one to the document management system?
  The accelerator's skills and calculation tools arrive as plugins.

- [ ] **Sensitivity labels**
  Which sensitivity labels apply to the practice's documents, and what do they allow Copilot to do?
  Copilot honors the usage rights that labels apply, so labels decide which documents a skill can use.

- [ ] **Retention**
  What retention applies in Microsoft Purview to Copilot and Cowork activity for the legal team?
  Prompts and responses about a matter usually belong under the same rules as the matter.

- [ ] **Deployment route**
  Will the practice add the pack itself in Cowork, or will IT deploy it with the administrator package?
  Organizations that run Information Barriers, as many law firms do, start with the IT-deployed route.

FOR LEGAL

Legal chooses the work and writes down the positions the AI will apply.

- [ ] **The first practice and tasks**
  Which practice comes first, and which two or three recurring tasks?
  A narrow start lets the week end with measured results on real work.

- [ ] **Today's baseline**
  How long does each task take today, how often does it arrive, and who does it?
  The baseline is what the team measures the results against.

- [ ] **Positions and fallbacks**
  For each task, what are the team's preferred positions, its fallbacks, and the points at which it escalates, and to whom?
  These positions become the team's playbooks, the layer the team owns.

- [ ] **Precedents and house style**
  Which templates, clauses, and precedents are approved, and where are they kept?
  They seed the knowledge library that the practice agent draws on.

- [ ] **AI work under way**
  Which prompts, skills, and pilots have lawyers already built in other AI tools?
  The first deployment builds on that work rather than starting again.

- [ ] **Owners**
  Who owns each position, and who signs off when a playbook changes?
  The team's positions will change as its practice does, and each change needs an owner.

Book a 30-minute scoping session

We review this checklist with your legal and IT leads and plan the week.

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